

Document: Parliament pushes to defend green rules in next EU budget

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By Marianne Gros · Oct 6, 2026, 12:59 PM · [View in your browser](#)

BRUSSELS — European lawmakers want to secure a chunk of the EU's next multi-year budget for biodiversity projects, according to a draft report obtained by POLITICO .

Written by MEPs from the budget and budgetary control committees, the report outlines the draft amendments to the European Commission's proposal for the so-called Performance Regulation. The proposal lays out horizontal principles and targets across the EU budget, including a target for green spending.

In its proposed Multiannual Financial Framework for the period 2028-2034, the Commission wants to set an overarching 35% target for climate and environmental spending.

According to the report — which was jointly drafted by European People's Party MEP Niclas Herbst and Socialist MEP Jean-Marc Germain —the MEPs suggest keeping that figure but add that, within this amount, biodiversity-specific activities should account for “at least the same level” as what the EU spends on biodiversity in its current budget.

The Commission also wants to apply the so-called “Do No Significant Harm” principle horizontally to the entire budget, which states that EU cash cannot be used to fund projects that would harm any of the bloc's environmental objectives. That proposal has fueled backlash from governments, business lobbies and the center-right European People's Party.

According to the report, the lawmakers want the Commission to work on a separate piece of legislation to create an “exhaustive list of activities” that are considered not to cause significant harm to the environment. This separate legal act should also list derogations from the rule, the MEPs suggest.

The Commission is already working on guidelines to complement its budget proposal explaining how the DNSH principle should work in practice. According to a draft of those guidelines seen by POLITICO, the executive is considering exempting spending for defense, security and crises and certain strategic projects.

Political groups in the two committees can still propose other amendments and will negotiate to reach a joint position on the file. The report would need to pass a vote in committee and plenary.

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